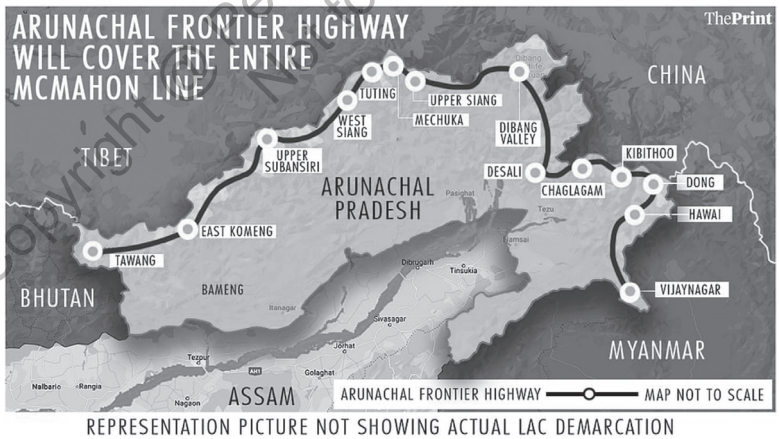
location in the Dibang Valley. The RM had spent some time in her early years in this area with the Mishimi tribe, so she too was keen on visiting this area. The visit underscored how little things had changed in the intervening decades and the urgent necessity of making roads to our border areas as well as lateral roads connecting all the valleys. In January 2008, the Trans Arunachal Highway (TAH) project was announced by then Prime Minister of India, Manmohan Singh, and by 2019, the project was well underway. However, the TAH ran mostly along the foothills of Arunachal and did not really address the issue of lateral connectivity between the valleys in the forward areas. The Centre therefore approved, in 2022, the construction of an Arunachal Frontier Highway in the forward areas running roughly parallel to the watershed.[4] This, more than the 2000-km-long TAH, will give the military a major capability boost. China predictably raised objections to the project while continuing the development of roads unabated, on their side of the LAC.

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